

a nuclear strike against the USA based on what turned out to actually be a malfunction. So even with the possibility of malfunctions, we have good people who will keep an eye on these machines, to make sure we don't kill ourselves.

Doomsday Scenario



National Ignition Facility

So first off, what is the NIF? Well, it's this really cool facility which is a part of the Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory in California. Why are they so cool?



Mishap at the National Ignition Facility – damn it who divided by Zero

Because they have lasers... lasers you hear! The NIF is a large facility that is used to study nuclear fusion, using lasers. They currently have the world's most powerful laser, an Ultraviolet laser that outputs 500 terawatts of laser-y goodness. If you're wondering how much power that is, it's more than the electricity consumption of the entire United States of America at any given instance of time. This laser is only fired in a single pulse burst to get a nuclear fusion reaction going (nuclear fusion reactions require somewhere close to a 100 million degrees just to start) and that pulse lasts only a few nanoseconds.

Those few Nano seconds are enough to ignite the heavy hydrogen fuel in the chamber to get a nuclear fusion reaction going. With starting temperature of about a 100 million degrees, the experiment is designed to release enough energy to make the reaction self-sustaining. One wrong move and we've got an artificial sun rampant on the surface of the planet. The reaction could continue in a sustained way, where the "sun" keeps releasing millions of degrees worth of heat onto the surface, destroying the atmosphere, and all life.

How to survive

How do you survive a blazing ball of fire that scorches the dance floor at a hundred million degrees? You don't. There's no amount of lemonade you can have to cool yourself off when the heat gets turned up that high.

Why it may not happen

Because the guys at NIF are pretty damn smart. They've got safety measures in place to not just shut the laser down before it delivers its energy in entirety, but also to arrest the nuclear fusion reaction.

The walls of the test chamber are made of concrete infused with Boron, which is a standard retardant in arresting nuclear reactions as it's an excellent absorber of stray neutrons and x-rays. If a nuclear reaction was to go rogue in this facility, it would be something that the scientists would become aware of well in time to do something about it.

Doomsday Scenario



Zombie apocalypse

Zombies! Who doesn't love them? Well, as long as they're not biting you. There's an entire empire of franchises behind the zombie culture, TV shows, movies, video games and a very hefty costume industry too. The most popular symbols of the Zombie culture in our times is Resident Evil, The Walking Dead, Left 4 Dead and the very popular movie Zombieland.

If you're thinking that things like the T-virus (or G-Virus, or C-virus, or any-other-letter-virus) is only a thing of the movies, then there is a possibility that you may be mistaken. Going out on a conspiracy theory limb here altogether, but how would you know for sure there isn't a super-secret underground facility right underneath your city? Or that a virus that can re-animate the dead doesn't already exist? There's actually a parasite named Toxoplasma that can control the brains of rats and guide them to impending doom and apparently, half (if not more) of the planet's population is already infected with

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